

Daily Shipping Trade Advisory

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Sattva Global Logistics

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The India-Pakistan cargo ban, triggered by the Pahalgam terror attack and subsequent military escalation, is now the dominant operational disruption in Indian subcontinent shipping as of 6 May 2026. Following India's prohibition on vessels carrying Pakistani-origin cargo from calling at Indian ports (effective approximately 2 May 2026), major carriers including CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd, MSC, ONE, and COSCO have restructured services — removing direct Karachi and Port Qasim calls and rerouting Pakistani cargo via transshipment hubs at Colombo and Khalifa Port (UAE). While the ban targets Pakistani cargo, Indian exporters face indirect disruption: service schedules on routes that previously called at both Pakistan and Indian ports are being revised mid-rotation, and transshipment hub congestion at Colombo is building. Additionally, Maersk has announced an ECS reduction for India-to-West Africa trades effective 11 May 2026 PCD — dropping from USD 800 to USD 400 per container — and a Peak Season Surcharge on ISC/Middle East to US West Coast activates from 21 May 2026 for non-spot bookings.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS TODAY

- **India-Pakistan Cargo Ban [CRITICAL]:** India has prohibited vessels carrying Pakistani-origin cargo from berthing at any Indian port (effective ~2 May 2026). Pakistan has reciprocated with a blanket ban on Indian goods transit.
- **CMA CGM Service Restructuring:** Five services revised; Karachi removed from three Europe/Med/intra-Asia routes; Port Qasim dropped from INDAMEX (India–USEC). USD 800/container Emergency Operational Recovery Surcharge announced for Pakistani cargo, effective 15 May 2026.
- **Hapag-Lloyd Shuttle & Surcharges:** Dedicated Sofia Express shuttle deployed Salalah–Karachi. Contingency surcharges announced: USD 500 outbound / USD 300 inbound (Pakistan↔Europe & Africa), effective 21 May 2026.
- **Colombo Transshipment Congestion Building:** Colombo is absorbing rerouted Pakistani cargo from multiple carriers; congestion risk for India-origin cargo transiting via Sri Lanka is elevated.
- **Maersk ECS India → West Africa REDUCTION:** ECS drops from USD 800 to USD 400 per container for all container types, effective Price Calculation Date 11 May 2026 (W2MW trade lane).
- **Maersk PSS ISC/ME → US West Coast:** Peak Season Surcharge activates 21 May 2026 for non-spot bookings. Specific per-container rate not published in accessible advisory text.

CARRIER-SPECIFIC UPDATES

CMA CGM

DISRUPTED

CMA CGM has restructured five services following India's prohibition on vessels carrying Pakistani cargo. Three services to Europe, Mediterranean, and intra-Asia have had Karachi port calls removed; Port Qasim has been dropped from the INDAMEX route (India–US East Coast). The CMA CGM Bianca turned back to Pakistan on approximately 1 May 2026 to offload cargo before proceeding to India. Transshipment via Colombo and Khalifa Port (UAE) is now the rerouted path for Pakistani cargo. CMA CGM has announced a USD 800 per container Emergency Operational Recovery Surcharge for Pakistani containers to Europe, Mediterranean, US, and Africa, effective 15 May 2026 (6 June 2026 for US, Latin America, and Australia lanes). Indian exporters on affected services should reconfirm port call sequences and ETDs directly with CMA CGM before gating in cargo.

Hapag-Lloyd

DISRUPTED

Hapag-Lloyd is deploying a dedicated shuttle vessel (Sofia Express) between Salalah and Karachi/Port Qasim for Pakistani cargo, while adjusting services that previously combined India and Pakistan port calls. The Nagoya Express diverted to Colombo on approximately 3 May 2026 rather than proceeding to Nhava Sheva, to offload Pakistani cargo before the Indian ban could take effect. Contingency surcharges announced effective 21 May 2026: USD 500 per

container outbound from Pakistan and USD 300 per container inbound to Pakistan, on Europe and Africa trades. Indian exporters should verify updated rotation schedules on any Hapag-Lloyd service that previously included Pakistani port calls.

Maersk

NORMAL

Maersk has reduced its Emergency Contingency Surcharge (ECS) for the Indian Subcontinent to West Africa trade (W2MW), effective Price Calculation Date 11 May 2026 — from USD 800 per container (all sizes) to USD 400 per container. The rate applies equally to 20DRY, 40DRY, 40HREF, 45HORY, and OOG/SOC/NOR containers. Separately, Maersk's Peak Season Surcharge (PSS) for ISC and Middle East to US and Canada West Coast takes effect 21 May 2026 for non-spot bookings. Specific per-container amounts were not published in the accessible advisory — verify at maersk.com/news.

MSC / ONE / COSCO

DISRUPTED

MSC, ONE, and COSCO have each announced suspension of scheduled port calls to Karachi and Port Qasim as a direct result of India's cargo ban. Specific revised service rotations and surcharge circulars for these carriers were not fully captured in today's source scan. Exporters booking with these carriers on India–Pakistan combined-port services should contact their booking representatives immediately to confirm revised schedules and any additional charges effective from mid-May 2026.

SURCHARGE TABLE

Carrier	Surcharge Name	Trade Lane / Notes	Eff. Date	TEU Amt	FEU Amt	CCY
Maersk	ECS — Emergency Contingency (REDUCTION)	ISC & Pakistan → West Africa (W2MW)	11 May 2026 (PCD)	USD 400	USD 400	USD
Maersk	PSS — Peak Season Surcharge	ISC & ME → US/Canada West Coast	21 May 2026 (non-spot)	N/C in source	N/C in source	USD
CMA CGM	Emergency Operational Recovery Surcharge	Pakistan-origin cargo to Europe, Med, US, Africa	15 May 2026 (6 Jun for US/LatAm/Aus)	USD 800/cntr	USD 800/cntr	USD
Hapag-Lloyd	Pakistan Contingency Surcharge — Outbound	Pakistan → Europe & Africa	21 May 2026	USD 500/cntr	USD 500/cntr	USD
Hapag-Lloyd	Pakistan Contingency Surcharge — Inbound	Europe & Africa → Pakistan	21 May 2026	USD 300/cntr	USD 300/cntr	USD

N/C in source = Not clearly specified in accessible advisory text. Verify directly with the carrier.

TRADE IMPACT ON INDIAN EXPORTERS

Exporters shipping FCL from Nhava Sheva (JNPT), Mundra, and Chennai face schedule uncertainty on services that previously combined India and Pakistan port calls — carriers including CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd, MSC, and ONE are actively revising rotations, and confirmed sailing sequences for May and June should be revalidated directly with your booking carrier before cargo is gated in. Colombo's role as a transshipment hub is under increased pressure from Pakistan cargo rerouting, which may add 2–5 days to transit times on India–Europe, India–Gulf, and India–USEC services transiting via Sri Lanka. Exporters shipping to West Africa with Maersk will benefit from the ECS reduction effective 11 May PCD — dropping from USD 800 to USD 400 per container — and should ensure their bookings reflect the updated charge. Exporters targeting US West Coast on non-spot Maersk bookings should confirm their surcharge exposure ahead of the 21 May 2026 PSS activation, as exact per-container rates should be obtained directly from Maersk. Overall, the India-Pakistan ban's indirect impact on Indian export services is significant enough to warrant a full re-check of booking confirmation details, routing, and final surcharge invoicing for all May and June shipments.

RECOMMENDED CONTINGENCY ACTIONS FOR EXPORTERS

1. Re-confirm sailing schedules for any booking on CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd, MSC, ONE, or COSCO services that previously included Pakistani port calls — rotations are being revised and ETDs may have shifted.

2. Request an updated surcharge quote from your freight forwarder for all bookings confirmed before 2 May 2026 — Emergency Operational Recovery and Contingency surcharges from CMA CGM and Hapag-Lloyd take effect from 15–21 May.
3. For exports transiting via Colombo — monitor congestion alerts and ask your carrier about alternative transshipment hubs (Port Klang, Khalifa Port) as surge volumes from Pakistani reroutes are adding pressure.
4. Maersk bookings to West Africa: ensure your price calculation reflects the new ECS of USD 400 per container (effective 11 May PCD) rather than the previous USD 800 — the reduction should be confirmed on your invoice.
5. Maersk bookings to US/Canada West Coast (non-spot): obtain the specific PSS rate applicable from 21 May 2026 before confirming your cargo value and margin assumptions.

SOURCES REFERENCED

- **Maersk Advisory – 4 May 2026**
<https://www.maersk.com/news/articles/2026/05/04/change-to-ecs-indian-subcontinent-to-west-africa>
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<https://www.maersk.com/news/articles/2026/04/20/pss-indian-subcontinent-middle-east-us-canada-west-coast>
- **Sourcing Journal – India-Pakistan Port Bans**
<https://sourcingjournal.com/topics/logistics/india-pakistan-port-bans-delays-freight-rates-capacity-cma-cgm-surcharges-terror-attack-1234747503/>
- **Sourcing Journal – Ocean Carriers Levy Surcharges**
<https://sourcingjournal.com/topics/logistics/pakistan-india-ports-ocean-carriers-surcharges-trade-msc-hapag-lloyd-cma-cgm-1234747928/>
- **The Loadstar – India-Pakistan Tit-for-Tat Cargo Ban**
<https://theloadstar.com/india-and-pakistan-tit-for-tat-cargo-ban-sparks-sudden-supply-chain-shocks/>
- **Safety4SEA – India and Pakistan Exchange Trade Bans**
<https://safety4sea.com/india-and-pakistan-exchange-trade-bans-and-port-restrictions/>
- **MarineInsight – Major Shipping Lines Avoid Pakistani Ports**
<https://www.marineinsight.com/shipping-news/major-shipping-lines-avoid-pakistani-ports-after-india-blocks-cargo-transit/>
- **India Shipping News**
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